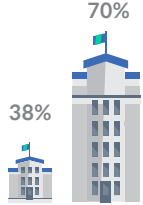


SUPPORTING KDE'S STRATEGIC RESEARCH PLAN AND STATE KINDERGARTEN READINESS GOALS

Kentucky Department of Education (KDE) needed a data-savvy partner to help address key questions on kindergarten readiness in its strategic research plan. By partnering with Hanover Research, KDE gathered key data on its progress toward its goal of 64.1% kindergarten readiness by 2017.

HANOVER APPROACH	1. Do students' kindergarten readiness rates differ by their Pre-K care settings?	2. Does the <i>availability</i> of each Pre-K care setting type differ across Kentucky's regional networks?	3. Do differences in the availability of Pre-K care settings correlate with the kindergarten readiness of a regional network?
	Descriptive Analyses: Hanover collected state-level public data to compare kindergarten readiness percentages between student groups from the following Pre-K care setting types: - State-funded - Head Start - Child Care/Private Preschool - Home Care - Other	Cross-Reference Data: To identify regional trends in Pre-K care setting availability, Hanover employed a three-step approach with district-level data: - Match districts to their corresponding regional networks - Aggregate district enrollments for all Pre-K care settings - Divide Pre-K care setting enrollments by total enrollments in each network to determine availability percentages	Regression Analyses: Hanover estimated associations between kindergarten readiness percentages and the number of Pre-K care settings available. Regression Formula: $KReady_s = \beta_0 + \beta_1 PriorSetting_s + \beta_2 X_s + \mu_{year} + \epsilon_i$ In other words: how does the number of available Pre-K care settings impact a network's kindergarten readiness when we control for the differences in school traits and variations over time?
KDE TAKEAWAY	Child Care Students are More Kindergarten Ready Students from child care settings have the highest kindergarten readiness rate (70%), while students from home settings have the lowest (38%). 	Gaps Exist in Pre-K Care Setting Availability - Certain regional networks have significantly fewer state-funded child care settings - State funded centers enroll the greatest percentage of students across the five networks 	Number of Available Settings Predicts Kindergarten Readiness Schools with four Pre-K care settings have a higher kindergarten readiness rate than schools with no prior settings (3.72 percentage points). 